

1990

1991
UN coalition expels Iraqi forces from Kuwait. Baltic republics assert independence from USSR. USSR dissolved, replaced by CIS. Slovenia and Croatia independent: at war with Serbia.

◀ Nelson Mandela

1995



▲ Boris Yeltsin

1996
Taliban captures Kabul: declares it to be a fundamentalist Islamic state. Russian pullout leaves Chechnya de facto independent. Yeltsin wins Russian elections: communists narrowly defeated. DVDs launched in Japan.

2000



◀ Twin Towers attack

2002
Euro introduced in 11 of 15 EU countries. Renewed Palestinian attacks on Israel. Mugabe wins rigged election in Zimbabwe: attacks on opponents. UN weapons inspections in Iraq.

2005 onward

2005
Muslim fundamentalist bombings in London: 52 die. Israel withdraws from Gaza; Syria withdraws from Lebanon. General election in Iraq: 98.8 percent turnout. Kyoto Protocol on climate change comes into force.

2008
Global financial crisis sends stock markets plummeting. Terrorist attacks in Mumbai, India; 175 die. Barack Obama is elected president of the United States.

2006
Sudan rejects UN peacekeeping force, launches genocide in Darfur; around 400,000 die. Renewed Israeli–Hezbollah conflict in Lebanon. North Korea tests nuclear weapon. Montenegro votes to split from Serbia.

2009
Bushfires in Australia kill 173. Hamid Karzai re-elected president of Afghanistan but Taliban attacks worsen. Outbreak of H1N1 “Swine flu” pandemic. Earthquake in Sumatra kills 1,000 people.

▼ Ads promote global companies

1990
Iraqi invasion of Kuwait: UN coalition forces sent to Persian Gulf. Moves to end apartheid in South Africa. Free elections held in East Germany; Germany reunited.

▼ Oslo Accords: Clinton, Arafat, and Rabin

1993
“Velvet Divorce”: Czech Republic and Slovakia formed from Czechoslovakia. Oslo Accords: PLO and Israel agree limited Palestinian autonomy. Democracy restored in Cambodia. HIV/AIDS epidemic in southern Africa.



1998
India and Pakistan test nuclear weapons. Serbs and ethnic Albanians clash in Kosovo. Economic crisis in Indonesia: overthrow of Suharto government. “Good Friday” peace deal, Northern Ireland.

◀ Petronas Towers



▼ Fall of Saddam Hussein

2003
Widespread ethnic conflict in Darfur, Sudan. US-led coalition invades Iraq; takes Baghdad; Saddam Hussein ousted; widespread violence and terror attacks; UN lifts sanctions. First manned Chinese space flight.



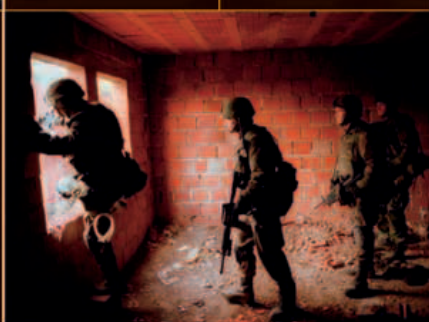
▼ AIDS ribbon

1994
Civil war in Rwanda: 500,000 Tutsis massacred; two million Hutus flee. ANC wins multiracial elections in South Africa. Chechnya asserts independence: Russian invasion. US invades Haiti: democracy restored.

1997
Britain returns Hong Kong to China. Asian financial crisis. Adult sheep, “Dolly,” cloned. Coup in Zaire. Israeli pullout from Hebron, West Bank. Microsoft is world’s most valuable company.

▼ NATO troops in Kosovo

1999
Russia restarts Chechen war. Serbian “ethnic cleansing” of Kosovan Albanians: NATO intervention. Renewed Indian–Pakistani clashes over Kashmir. Democracy restored in Indonesia. US and UK begin air attacks on Iraq.



2001
Al-Qaeda terror attacks on New York and Washington, DC: President Bush commits US to “war on terror.” US–UK coalition forces bomb Afghanistan: Taliban overthrown.

2004
Muslim fundamentalist bombings in Madrid: 191 die. Chechen separatists storm school in Baslan, Russia: 350 die. Indonesian earthquake sparks tsunami, in SE Asia and Indian Ocean: over 210,000 die. Ten new countries join EU.

2007
Iran develops nuclear program despite international pressure and UN sanctions. Devolved government returns to Northern Ireland. Sectarian conflict between Sunni and Shia militias escalates in occupied Iraq.

2010
Earthquake in Haiti leaves 230,000 dead. Deepwater Horizon oil platform explodes in Gulf of Mexico, starting oil leak that takes six months to plug. Aung San Suu Kyi is released from house arrest by Burmese military.

Wind power ▶

